

Recognise cells as the basic units of living things, compare plant and animal cells, and describe the functions of specialised cell structures and organelles

Learning intention

- recognise cells as the basic units of living things, compare plant and animal cells, and describe the functions of specialised cell structures and organelles.

Teach and model

- considering how the invention of the microscope has contributed to understanding of cell structure.
- designing a physical or digital model of a cell and explaining how the representation models the cell.
- exploring an augmented or virtual reality tour of a plant or animal to 'zoom in' and understand the scale of cells.

Check understanding

- Explain the main idea and give one accurate example.
- Show the idea in a second way: with words, a model, a diagram or symbols.
- Apply the idea to a short unfamiliar situation and justify the result.

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Teaching cautions

- Ask the student to explain their choice, not only state an answer.
- Check that key vocabulary is understood in a new example.
- Mix representations so the skill is transferred rather than copied.

Quick lesson sequence

- Connect to prior knowledge and introduce the key vocabulary.
- Model one clear example, then solve a second example together.
- Finish with an independent check and a short student explanation.